

D&D 3.5e Wondrous Items — Priority Matrix

Source: Dungeon Master’s Guide 3.5e, Pages 246-265
Companion to: wondrous_items_implementation_plan.md
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PRIORITY SCORING METHODOLOGY

Each item is scored on four dimensions (1-5 scale each):

Dimension	Weight	Description
Player Demand	30%	How frequently players use this item
System Reusability	25%	How much shared infrastructure the item contributes
Implementation Ease	25%	How straightforward to implement (5 = easy)
Game Impact	20%	How significantly the item affects gameplay

Priority Score = (Demand × 0.30) + (Reusability × 0.25) + (Ease × 0.25) + (Impact × 0.20)

Priority Bands:

-  **P1 Critical** (4.0-5.0): Must-have, implement first
-  **P2 Important** (3.0-3.9): High value, implement in early phases
-  **P3 Standard** (2.0-2.9): Implement when capacity allows
-  **P4 Low** (1.0-1.9): Implement last or defer

PRIORITY MATRIX BY PHASE

 PHASE 1: FOUNDATION (Weeks 1-2) — Priority: CRITICAL

No individual items — infrastructure only.

System Component	Reusability	Items Enabled	Priority
Equipment Slot System	5	All worn items (~70)	● P1
WondrousItem Base Class	5	All wondrous items (~130)	● P1
Bonus Management System	5	All passive items (~45)	● P1
Activation Framework	5	All active items (~50)	● P1
Daily Use Tracker	4	~20 items	● P1
Database Schema	5	All items	● P1

 PHASE 2: ABILITY SCORE ITEMS (Weeks 3-4) — Priority: CRITICAL

Item	Demand	Reuse	Ease	Impact	Score	Priority
Headband of Intellect +2	5	5	5	4	4.80	● P1
Cloak of Charisma +2	5	5	5	4	4.80	● P1
Gauntlets of Ogre Power	5	5	5	4	4.80	● P1
Gloves of Dexterity +2	5	5	5	4	4.80	● P1
Amulet of Health +2	5	5	5	4	4.80	● P1
Periapt of Wisdom +2	5	5	5	4	4.80	● P1
Belt of Giant Strength +4	5	4	5	4	4.55	● P1
Gloves of Dexterity +4	5	4	5	4	4.55	● P1
Amulet of Health +4	5	4	5	4	4.55	● P1
Headband of Intellect +4	5	4	5	4	4.55	● P1
Periapt of Wisdom +4	5	4	5	4	4.55	● P1
Cloak of Charisma +4	5	4	5	4	4.55	● P1

Item	Demand	Reuse	Ease	Impact	Score	Priority
+6 variants (×6)	4	3	5	4	3.95	● P2

Rationale: Every character in D&D 3.5e uses ability score items. The “Big Six” (+2 enhancement items at 4,000 gp each) are the most commonly purchased magic items in the game. The template pattern established here serves all 18 variants.

 PHASE 3: AC & SAVE ITEMS (Weeks 5-6) — Priority: CRITICAL

Item	Demand	Reuse	Ease	Impact	Score	Priority
Cloak of Resistance +1	5	5	5	5	5.00	● P1
Cloak of Resistance +2	5	4	5	5	4.75	● P1
Cloak of Resistance +3	5	4	5	5	4.75	● P1
Amulet of Natural Armor +1	5	4	5	5	4.75	● P1
Amulet of Natural Armor +2	5	4	5	5	4.75	● P1
Bracers of Armor +1	5	4	5	5	4.75	● P1
Bracers of Armor +2	5	4	5	5	4.75	● P1
Bracers of Armor +3-+5	4	3	5	4	3.95	● P2
Bracers of Armor +6-+8	3	3	5	4	3.65	● P2
Cloak of Resistance +4-+5	4	3	5	5	4.20	● P1
Amulet of Natural Armor +3-+5	4	3	5	5	4.20	● P1
Cloak of Displacement, Minor	4	4	3	5	3.95	● P2

Item	Demand	Reuse	Ease	Impact	Score	Priority
Cloak of Displacement, Major	3	3	3	5	3.40	● P2

Rationale: Cloak of Resistance is THE most universal magic item in 3.5e — literally every optimized character owns one. Natural armor amulets and bracers of armor are the next most common defensive items.

PHASE 4: MOVEMENT ITEMS (Weeks 7-8) — Priority: IMPORTANT

Item	Demand	Reuse	Ease	Impact	Score	Priority
Boots of Speed	5	3	3	5	4.00	 P1
Boots of Elvenkind	4	3	5	3	3.75	 P2
Boots of Striding and Springing	4	3	5	3	3.75	 P2
Winged Boots	4	4	3	4	3.75	 P2
Wings of Flying	3	3	3	4	3.20	 P2
Boots of Levitation	3	3	4	3	3.25	 P2
Slippers of Spider Climbing	3	3	4	3	3.25	 P2
Boots of the Winterlands	2	2	4	2	2.50	 P3
Boots of Teleportation	3	3	2	5	3.20	 P2
Carpet of Flying (×3)	2	3	3	3	2.75	 P3
Horse-shoes of Speed	2	2	5	2	2.65	 P3
Horse-shoes of a Zephyr	1	2	4	2	2.15	 P3

Rationale: Boots of Speed (haste 10 rds/day) is one of the most powerful and popular wondrous items. Flight items are critical for mid-to-high level play. Movement mechanics enable many gameplay scenarios.

PHASE 5: STEALTH & DETECTION (Weeks 9-10) — Priority: IMPORTANT

Item	Demand	Reuse	Ease	Impact	Score	Priority
Cloak of Elvenkind	4	3	5	3	3.75	 P2
Goggles of Night	4	3	4	3	3.55	 P2
Hat of Disguise	4	3	4	3	3.55	 P2
Eyes of the Eagle	3	3	5	2	3.25	 P2
Goggles of Minute Seeing	3	3	5	2	3.25	 P2
Circlet of Persuasion	4	2	5	3	3.55	 P2
Lens of Detection	3	2	5	2	2.95	 P3
Dust of Appearance	2	2	3	3	2.45	 P3
Dust of Disappearance	3	2	3	3	2.75	 P3
Dust of Tracelessness	1	2	4	1	1.90	 P4
Amulet of Proof Against Detection	2	2	3	3	2.45	 P3
Lantern of Revealing	2	2	3	3	2.45	 P3

PHASE 6: STORAGE ITEMS (Weeks 11-12) — Priority: IMPORTANT

Item	Demand	Reuse	Ease	Impact	Score	Priority
Handy Haversack	5	4	3	4	4.05	 P1
Bag of Holding Type I	5	5	3	4	4.30	 P1
Bag of Holding Type II	4	4	3	3	3.55	 P2
Bag of Holding Type III	3	3	3	3	3.00	 P2
Bag of Holding Type IV	3	3	3	3	3.00	 P2
Efficient Quiver	4	3	3	3	3.30	 P2
Portable Hole	3	3	3	4	3.20	 P2
Folding Boat	2	2	3	2	2.25	 P3
Decanter of Endless Water	3	2	3	2	2.55	 P3
Eversmoking Bottle	2	2	3	2	2.25	 P3
Bottle of Air	2	2	4	2	2.50	 P3
Sustaining Spoon	1	1	5	1	1.80	 P4

Rationale: Handy Haversack and Bag of Holding are nearly universal equipment. The container system built here enables all future storage items.

● PHASE 7: COMBAT ITEMS (Weeks 13-15) — Priority: STANDARD

Item	Demand	Reuse	Ease	Impact	Score	Priority
Bracers of Archery, Lesser	4	2	4	3	3.30	● P2
Bracers of Archery, Greater	3	2	4	3	3.00	● P2
Necklace of Fireballs III	3	4	3	4	3.45	● P2
Necklace of Fireballs (other types)	2	3	3	3	2.70	● P3
Bead of Force	2	2	3	3	2.45	● P3
Horn of Blasting	2	2	3	3	2.45	● P3
Iron Bands of Binding	2	2	2	3	2.20	● P3
Gauntlet of Rust	2	1	3	2	2.00	● P3
Gloves of Arrow Snaring	3	2	3	3	2.75	● P3

 PHASE 8: SUMMONING ITEMS (Weeks 16-18) — Priority: STANDARD

Item	Demand	Reuse	Ease	Impact	Score	Priority
Bag of Tricks (Gray)	3	4	3	3	3.25	● P2
Bag of Tricks (Rust)	3	3	3	3	3.00	● P2
Bag of Tricks (Tan)	3	3	3	3	3.00	● P2
Figurine — Silver Raven	2	3	3	2	2.50	● P3
Figurine — Bronze Griffon	2	3	3	3	2.70	● P3
Figurine — Ebony Fly	3	3	3	3	3.00	● P2
Figurine — Golden Lions	2	2	2	3	2.20	● P3
Figurine — Marble Elephant	2	2	2	3	2.20	● P3
Figurine — Ivory Goats	2	2	2	3	2.20	● P3
Figurine — Obsidian Steed	2	2	2	3	2.20	● P3
Elemental Gem (×4)	3	3	3	3	3.00	● P2
Horn of Valhalla (Silver)	1	2	2	3	1.90	● P4
	1	2	2	3	1.90	● P4

Item	Demand	Reuse	Ease	Impact	Score	Priority
Horn of Valhalla (Brass)						
Horn of Valhalla (Bronze)	1	2	2	3	1.90	 P4

 PHASE 9: IOUN STONES (Weeks 19-20) — Priority: STANDARD

Item	Demand	Reuse	Ease	Impact	Score	Priority
Dusty Rose Prism (+1 AC)	4	3	3	3	3.30	● P2
Pale Green Prism (+1 all)	4	3	3	4	3.50	● P2
Orange Prism (+1 CL)	3	2	3	4	2.95	● P3
Ability score stones (×6)	3	4	3	3	3.25	● P2
Clear Spindle (sustenance)	2	2	4	1	2.20	● P3
Iridescent Spindle (no air)	2	2	4	1	2.20	● P3
Pearly White Spindle (regen)	3	2	3	3	2.75	● P3
Dark Blue Rhomboid (Alertness)	2	2	3	2	2.25	● P3
Pale Lavender Ellipsoid (absorb)	3	3	2	4	2.95	● P3
Vibrant Purple Prism (store)	2	3	2	4	2.65	● P3
	2	2	2	4	2.40	● P3

Item	Demand	Reuse	Ease	Impact	Score	Priority
Lavender and Green Ellipsoid						

● PHASE 10: SPECIAL ROBES & COMPLEX (Weeks 21-23) —
Priority: STANDARD

Item	Demand	Reuse	Ease	Impact	Score	Priority
Monk's Belt	4	2	2	4	3.00	● P2
Robe of Useful Items	2	3	2	2	2.25	● P3
Robe of Bones	2	2	2	2	2.00	● P3
Robe of Stars	2	2	1	4	2.15	● P3
Robe of Scintillating Colors	2	2	2	3	2.20	● P3
Robe of Blending	2	2	4	2	2.50	● P3
Cloak of Arachnida	3	2	2	3	2.50	● P3
Cloak of the Bat	2	2	2	3	2.20	● P3
Helm of Telepathy	2	2	2	3	2.20	● P3
Cube of Force	2	2	1	4	2.15	● P3
Rope of Entanglement	2	2	2	3	2.20	● P3
Cube of Frost Resistance	1	2	2	2	1.70	● P4
Druid's Vestment	2	1	3	2	2.00	● P3

CONSUMABLE & MISC ITEM PRIORITIES

Elixirs (7 items)

Item	Price	Priority	Rationale
Elixir of Fire Breath	1,100 gp	 P3	Useful combat consumable
Elixir of Truth	500 gp	 P3	Social encounter utility
Elixir of Hiding	250 gp	 P4	Superseded by magic items
Elixir of Tumbling	250 gp	 P4	Niche use
Elixir of Swimming	250 gp	 P4	Niche use
Elixir of Vision	250 gp	 P4	Niche use
Elixir of Love	150 gp	 P4	RP item

Feather Tokens (6 items)

Item	Price	Priority	Rationale
Swan Boat	450 gp	 P3	Utility
Tree	400 gp	 P4	Niche
Bird	300 gp	 P3	Message delivery
Whip	500 gp	 P4	Niche combat
Fan	200 gp	 P4	Niche
Anchor	50 gp	 P4	Very niche

Pearls of Power (8 items in scope)

Item	Price	Priority	Rationale
Pearl of Power (1st)	1,000 gp	 P1	Extremely popular for spellcasters
Pearl of Power (2nd)	4,000 gp	 P2	Very popular
Pearl of Power (3rd)	9,000 gp	 P2	Popular
Pearl of Power (4th)	16,000 gp	 P2	Common at mid levels
Pearl of Power (5th)	25,000 gp	 P3	Used at higher levels
Pearl of Power (6th)	36,000 gp	 P3	Used at higher levels
Pearl of Power (7th)	49,000 gp	 P3	Used at high levels
Pearl of Power (8th)	64,000 gp	 P4	Rare, very high level

Miscellaneous Consumables

Item	Price	Priority	Rationale
Restorative Ointment	4,000 gp	 P2	Healing utility
Incense of Meditation	4,900 gp	 P2	Popular with divine casters
Salve of Slipperiness	1,000 gp	 P3	Freedom of movement
Sovereign Glue	2,400 gp	 P4	Situational
Universal Solvent	50 gp	 P4	Counter to Sovereign Glue
Stone Salve	4,000 gp	 P3	Counter to petrification
Silversheen	250 gp	 P2	DR bypass, common need
Unguent of Timelessness	150 gp	 P4	Niche flavor item

Miscellaneous Permanent

Item	Price	Priority	Rationale
Scarab of Protection	38,000 gp	● P2	Death/drain protection
Periapt of Proof Against Poison	27,000 gp	● P2	Poison immunity
Phylactery of Undead Turning	11,000 gp	● P3	Cleric-specific
Brooch of Shielding	1,500 gp	● P2	Common anti-magic-missile
Necklace of Adaptation	9,000 gp	● P2	Environmental protection
Stone of Good Luck	20,000 gp	● P2	Universal +1 luck bonus
Stone of Alarm	2,700 gp	● P3	Camp security
Golembane Scarab	2,500 gp	● P4	Very situational
Chime of Opening	3,000 gp	● P3	Lock bypass
Rope of Climbing	3,000 gp	● P3	Dungeon utility
Horn of Fog	2,000 gp	● P4	Limited use
Pipes of Sounding	1,800 gp	● P4	Limited use
Pipes of the Sewers	1,150 gp	● P4	Very niche
Mattock of the Titans	23,348 gp	● P4	Large creature only
Gem of Brightness	13,000 gp	● P3	Versatile light/blind item
Lyre of Building	13,000 gp	● P4	Construction niche
Hand of the Mage	900 gp	● P3	Cheap cantrip item
Vest of Escape	5,200 gp	● P3	Escape utility

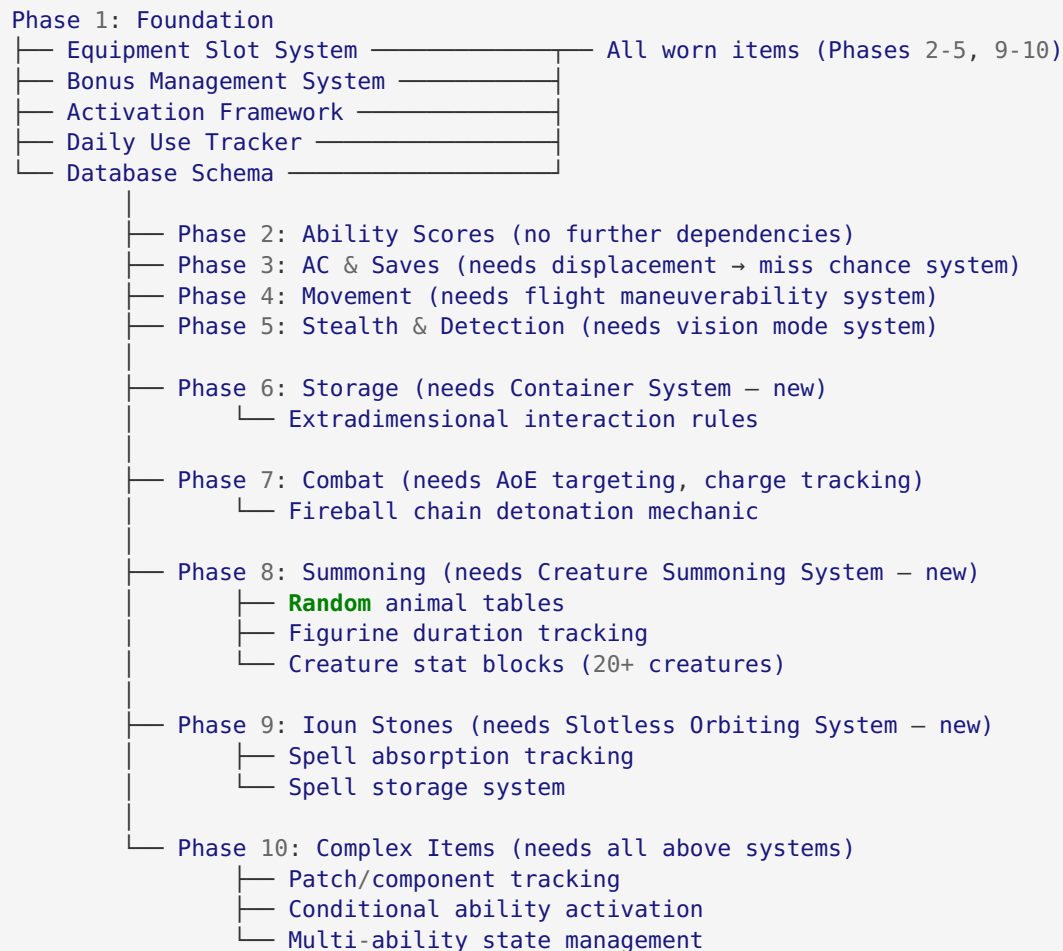
MASTER PRIORITY LIST — TOP 30 ITEMS

Sorted by priority score (highest first):

Rank	Item	Score	Phase	Tier
1	Cloak of Resistance +1	5.00	3	1
2	Headband of Intellect +2	4.80	2	1
3	Cloak of Charisma +2	4.80	2	1
4	Gauntlets of Ogre Power	4.80	2	1
5	Gloves of Dexterity +2	4.80	2	1
6	Amulet of Health +2	4.80	2	1
7	Periapt of Wisdom +2	4.80	2	1
8	Amulet of Natural Armor +1	4.75	3	1
9	Bracers of Armor +1	4.75	3	1
10	Cloak of Resistance +2	4.75	3	1
11	Belt of Giant Strength +4	4.55	2	1
12	Gloves of Dexterity +4	4.55	2	1
13	Amulet of Health +4	4.55	2	1
14	Headband of Intellect +4	4.55	2	1
15	Periapt of Wisdom +4	4.55	2	1
16	Cloak of Charisma +4	4.55	2	1

Rank	Item	Score	Phase	Tier
17	Bag of Holding Type I	4.30	6	3
18	Cloak of Resistance +4	4.20	3	1
19	Amulet of Natural Armor +3	4.20	3	1
20	Handy Haversack	4.05	6	3
21	Boots of Speed	4.00	4	2
22	Pearl of Power (1st)	3.95	2	2
23	Cloak of Displacement, Minor	3.95	3	2
24	Boots of Elvenkind	3.75	4	1
25	Cloak of Elvenkind	3.75	5	1
26	Winged Boots	3.75	4	2
27	Circlet of Persuasion	3.55	5	1
28	Goggles of Night	3.55	5	2
29	Hat of Disguise	3.55	5	2
30	Necklace of Fireballs III	3.45	7	4

DEPENDENCY GRAPH



SPRINT PLANNING TEMPLATE

Sprint W1 (Week 1): Foundation Part 1

- [] Define EquipmentSlot enum with all 10+ slots
- [] Implement WondrousItem base class
- [] Create BonusManager for stacking rules
- [] Define BonusType enum (enhancement, competence, resistance, luck, insight, etc.)
- [] Create database schema for wondrous items

Sprint W2 (Week 2): Foundation Part 2

- [] Implement activation framework (continuous, command word, use-activated)
- [] Implement DailyUseTracker
- [] Implement ChargeTracker
- [] Create WondrousItemFactory
- [] Write foundation unit tests

Sprint W3 (Week 3): Ability Scores — +2 Items

- [] Implement all 6 ability score +2 items

- [] Verify bonus application and removal
- [] Verify non-stacking with same type
- [] Verify ability modifier recalculation

Sprint W4 (Week 4): Ability Scores — +4/+6 Items

- [] Implement all 12 ability score +4/+6 items
- [] Full regression testing on ability score system

Sprint W5 (Week 5): AC Items

- [] Implement Bracers of Armor +1 to +8
- [] Implement Amulet of Natural Armor +1 to +5
- [] Verify armor bonus vs natural armor bonus stacking rules

Sprint W6 (Week 6): Save Items + Displacement

- [] Implement Cloak of Resistance +1 to +5
- [] Implement miss chance system
- [] Implement Cloak of Displacement Minor/Major
- [] Implement Scarab of Protection

Sprint W7-W8 (Weeks 7-8): Movement Items

- [] Implement speed modifiers (Boots of Striding)
- [] Implement flight system (Winged Boots, Wings of Flying)
- [] Implement haste tracking (Boots of Speed)
- [] Implement special movement (Spider Climbing, Levitation)
- [] Implement teleportation (Boots of Teleportation)

Sprint W9-W10 (Weeks 9-10): Stealth, Detection, Skills

- [] Implement all skill bonus items
- [] Implement darkvision mode (Goggles of Night)
- [] Implement disguise mechanics (Hat of Disguise)
- [] Implement consumable dust items

Sprint W11-W12 (Weeks 11-12): Storage

- [] Implement Container base class
- [] Implement Bag of Holding Types I-IV
- [] Implement Handy Haversack
- [] Implement extradimensional nesting rules
- [] Implement Portable Hole

Sprint W13-W15 (Weeks 13-15): Combat + Summoning

- [] Implement Necklace of Fireballs (all types)
- [] Implement AoE damage mechanics
- [] Implement Bag of Tricks (all types)
- [] Implement Figurines of Wondrous Power (9 types)
- [] Implement Elemental Gems (4 types)

Sprint W16-W18 (Weeks 16-18): Ioun Stones

- [] Implement slotless orbiting system

- [] Implement all 16 Ioun Stone types
- [] Implement spell absorption mechanics
- [] Implement burn-out tracking

Sprint W19-W23 (Weeks 19-23): Complex Items + Polish

- [] Implement multi-ability robes
- [] Implement Helm of Telepathy
- [] Implement Cube of Force
- [] Implement remaining items
- [] Integration testing
- [] Edge case testing

RISK-ADJUSTED TIMELINE

Phase	Best Case	Expected	Worst Case	Risk Level
Foundation	1.5 weeks	2 weeks	3 weeks	Low
Ability Scores	1 week	2 weeks	2 weeks	Low
AC & Saves	1.5 weeks	2 weeks	3 weeks	Medium (displacement)
Movement	1.5 weeks	2 weeks	3 weeks	Medium (flight)
Stealth & Detection	1.5 weeks	2 weeks	2.5 weeks	Low
Storage	1.5 weeks	2 weeks	3 weeks	Medium (nesting rules)
Combat	2 weeks	3 weeks	4 weeks	High (AoE + chain detonation)
Summoning	2 weeks	3 weeks	4 weeks	High (creature stats)
Ioun Stones	1.5 weeks	2 weeks	3 weeks	Medium (new subsystem)
Complex Items	2 weeks	3 weeks	4 weeks	High (integration)
Total	16 weeks	23 weeks	31.5 weeks	

MILESTONE CHECKPOINTS

Milestone	Week	Items Complete	Cumulative %
M1: Foundation complete	2	0 (infrastructure)	0%
M2: "Big Six" ability items	4	18	14%
M3: AC + Save items	6	38	29%
M4: Movement items	8	50	38%
M5: Stealth + Skills	10	62	48%
M6: Storage system	12	77	59%
M7: Combat items	15	92	71%
M8: Summoning items	18	112	86%
M9: Ioun Stones	20	128	98%
M10: Complex + Polish	23	130	100%

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